



Membership Policy

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VERSION 1.0

WARNING!

Information contained in this document is intended
for flight simulation purposes only.

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Purpose of Document

This document establishes the official Membership Policy for VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa (VATSSA). It sets out the conduct and expectations that new and existing members of VATSSA shall follow when participating in any divisional activities within VATSSA. VATSSA staff reserve the right to take action against any user found to be breaching this policy. This policy has been developed to achieve the following objectives:

- To establish clear standards of conduct and professionalism for all members.
- To define the rights, responsibilities and expectations of users participating in VATSSA activities and operations.
- To ensure compliance with all of VATSIM's policies, specifically GCAP, CoC and TVCP.
- To provide a clear guide to VATSSA's transfer process.
- To provide a clear guide to VATSSA's visiting process.

VATSSA is committed to delivering a professional, supportive and safe environment for all, regardless of their home division. As such, this policy applies to both members and anybody participating in VATSSA activities, operations or engaging through VATSSA platforms.

1. Control Pages

1.1. Document Identification

Type	Policy
Revision	05/2026
Issue Date	
Effective Date	
Prepared By	Josh Martin & Liyema Jacobs
Approved By	Wian Saptouw – VATSSA1 (Division Director)
Next Review Due	1st January 2027
Identification	VATSSA_POL_Membership_05-2026.pdf

1.2. Revision Records

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	05/2026	Initial Policy Drafted	Josh Martin & Liyema Jacobs

2. General Provisions

2.1. Applicability

This policy applies to all members and visitors of the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa division, regardless of their home region. It also applies to those interacting with VATSSA members and associated virtual airlines. Members are responsible for familiarising themselves with the contents of this policy, as well as any relevant VATSIM policies. The Membership Department holds full discretion to waive or amend aspects of this policy as necessary for VATSSA's benefit.

The content of this document reflects the essential modifications and regulations concerning the Code of Conduct (CoC), Global Controller Administration Policy (GCAP) and the Transfer and Visiting Controller Policy (TVCP).

2.2. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in one or more disciplinary actions as outlined in Section 4. VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa Membership reserves the right to suspend or terminate any user's ATC training, Discord presence and controlling privileges pending further investigation by VATSIM's Supervisors Department and Standards and Compliance Department.

2.3. Changes

This policy is subject to periodic review and amendment. Amendments may be made by the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa Membership Department as required to address its clarity and effectiveness. Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, which will be published at vatssa.com.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Staff Member	Any member of the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa staff team.
Membership Manager (VATSSA3)	The person responsible for overseeing the VATSSA Membership Department.
Deputy Membership Manager (VATSSA10)	The person who reports to VATSSA3 and assists with the Membership Department.
SUP	Any member of the VATSIM Supervisors Department.
SCM	VATSIM's Standards and Compliance Department.
CoC	The VATSIM Code of Conduct.
GCAP	The VATSIM Global Controller Administration Policy.
TVCP	The VATSIM Transfer and Visiting Controller Policy.

4. Membership

4.1. Applicability

Membership in VATSSA is open to any member of the VATSIM Europe, Middle East and Africa Region in accordance with divisional and global policies.

Any individual whose division in the VATSIM database is designated as “Sub-Sahara Africa” shall automatically be recognised as a VATSSA member.

4.2 Membership Queries

Queries relating to Membership within VATSSA, including membership status, transfers, visiting, ATC training applications and access to divisional services shall be directed to the VATSSA Membership department through the SSA Help Desk. The SSA Help Desk can be found within the SSA Discord Server, which can be accessed via <https://community.vatsim.net>.

The Membership Department endeavours to respond to all membership queries within 24 hours. Response times may vary due to operational workload and staffing capacity.

Where extenuating circumstances prohibit the handling of a query, the member shall be notified accordingly as soon as reasonably practicable.

4.3 Complaints Procedure

Complaints are directed to VATSSA3 (Membership Manager). VATSSA3's primary role is to assess and take action in accordance with divisional and global policies. The following steps will be taken:

- Review all relevant evidence, records and statements;
- Determine whether any divisional or global policies have been breached;
- Acknowledge receipt of the report to the member;
- Notify the member who is subject to the complaint of the allegations or concerns raised;
- Issue an outcome or resolution as considered appropriate;
- Inform VATSSA1 (Division Director) of any sanctions imposed or actions taken.

4.4 Member Standing

Members shall remain in good standing within VATSIM and VATSSA at all times.

A member's historical record, including previous interactions with VATSSA staff and terminal history, will be taken into consideration when determining or administering member privileges within the division, including but not limited to:

- Eligibility for transfer into VATSSA;
- Restrictions on ATC training and controller privileges;
- Suitability for staff positions.

VATSSA reserves the right to restrict or revoke access to divisional services and infrastructure, including ATC training services and communication platforms, in accordance with this policy and other applicable divisional policies.

4.5 Professional Standards

4.5.1. General Information

VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa is a voluntary community promoting flight simulations and virtual air traffic control, bringing together members who share a common interest in these activities.

All members are required to comply with all VATSIM policies while utilising VATSIM-owned or operated services, including but not limited to:

- VATSIM Code of Conduct
- VATSIM Code of Regulations
- VATSIM Safeguarding Minors Policy
- VATSIM User Agreement

4.5.2 Reporting Policy Breaches

Whilst the VATSIM Supervisors Department is the governing body responsible for breaches of network policies, VATSSA Membership is responsible for enforcing local policies. While ownership of the VATSSA Discord server lies with VATSSA1, all staff members are appointed as moderators and are responsible for maintaining the integrity of the VATSSA Discord server. However, formal enforcement actions and member sanctions remain the responsibility of the VATSSA Membership Department. The Membership Department serves in an oversight capacity for the VATSSA Discord server, and the management of the Discord lies with VATSSA3.

Members are encouraged to report any breaches of divisional or global policy through the appropriate reporting channels, including:

- **Via email feedback@vatssa.com**
- **Via email to VATSSA3**
- **Via email to VATSSA1**
- Via email to membership@vatssa.com
- Via the SSA Help Desk

Members are expected to familiarise themselves with VATSSA policy, which can be found via policy.vatssa.com.

4.5.3 Member Conduct

All members are expected to conduct themselves professionally when engaging with VATSSA infrastructure, specifically our communication platforms. Expectations include but are not limited to:

- **Foul language:** The use of foul or offensive language is strictly prohibited. VATSSA promotes a safe and respectful environment for all members.

- **Illegal activity:** Members are strictly prohibited from discussing, encouraging, or promoting any actions that may constitute illegal activity.
- **Harassment & discrimination:** Harassment, bullying, hate speech, or any form of discrimination on the basis of race, nationality, gender, religion, or any other protected characteristic is strictly prohibited.
- **Respectful communication:** Members must engage in respectful and constructive communication at all times, even in disagreement or debate.
- **Impersonation:** Impersonation of staff, controllers, pilots or any other member of the community is strictly prohibited. Members are prohibited from acting in a moderator capacity.
- **Spam & disruption:** Excessive or disruptive messaging, including the use of block capitals for the purpose of gaining another member's attention, is strictly prohibited.
- **VATSIM policy:** Members are reminded that VATSIM policy applies to all communication made within or as a result of the VATSSA Discord server.
- **Member compliance:** Members must follow reasonable instructions issued by VATSSA staff.

4.5.4 Disciplinary Actions

VATSSA reserves the right to take any disciplinary action necessary to uphold these standards, including but not limited to:

- **Informal Action:** Guidance issued to a member, either publicly or privately, to address conduct that does not comply with our standards.
- **Deletion of content:** Deletion of content that breaches our standards. This should be accompanied by an informal warning.
- **Timeout:** A short-term restriction on a member's ability to post within Discord. This should be accompanied by an informal warning.
- **Temporary suspension:** Prevents a member from accessing VATSSA infrastructure for a pre-defined period of time. The member will be notified of the reason for suspension via email.
- **Permanent suspension:** Prevents a member from accessing VATSSA infrastructure indefinitely. The member will be notified of the reason for suspension via email.
- **Referral to VATSIM Supervisors Department:** Used where a member's conduct breaches VATSIM network policy and may lead to additional disciplinary measures, including a network suspension or referral to the Standards and Compliance Department. VATSSA reserves the right to apply sanctions concurrently with this referral.

4.5.4 Appeals Process

A member has the right to appeal any moderation action via email to VATSSA1 and VATSSA3. All appeals are subject to a timely review, which includes but is not limited to:

- Verification of the sanctions imposed and applied policy.
- Independent review of all supporting evidence and communications.
- Assessment of procedural fairness and proportionality of the action taken.
- Consultation with the case officer.
- Referral to a Review Board for independent assessment where required.

5. Transferring

5.1 Transfer Periods

As per the VATSIM TVCP section 4.7, a controller has 90 days to complete their transfer, termed the "Transfer Period". If a controller no longer wishes to complete a Local Induction Plan or has not completed it within the Transfer Period, then the controller shall be transferred back to their previous allocation and will no longer be a transferring controller.

5.2 General Eligibility

As per TVCP section 4.3, a transfer request is not permitted until 90 days after:

- A new Rating is awarded
- Completing a transfer
- Being returned to an Allocation having failed to complete a transfer.

5.3 Transfers to VATSSA

5.3.1 General Information

This section outlines the procedures and requirements for transferring into VATSSA. Controllers applying for transfer will not be considered full members of the division until all specified requirements have been satisfied.

If a controller is unable to comply with any assigned training plan or transfer requirements set by VATSSA, their transfer request will be denied and the controller will be returned to their previous division. A new transfer application may only be submitted after a 90-day waiting period has passed.

5.3.2 Eligibility & Restrictions

Observer Rating (OBS)

- A VATSIM member may transfer to VATSSA with an OBS rating as long as they have not transferred Region or Division within the last 90 days.

Developing Controller (S1) and above

- A VATSIM member may transfer to VATSSA with a controller rating of S1 or above as long as they have not transferred Region or Division within the last 90 days.
- A member may only transfer when they have held their rating for 90 days or more.
- A member may only transfer when they have controlled 50 hours on Positions that require their current Rating in their Home Allocation.

Instructor Ratings

- Instructor ratings are not transferrable. Should a VATSIM member transfer to VATSSA, they will lose their instructor rating and revert to their previously held rating.

5.3.3 Processing and Possible Rejection

VATSSA must accept all reasonable transfer requests and process them by the most expeditious means. An application may be rejected if:

- The member is not eligible for transfer.
- The member has documented history which must be taken into consideration.
- At the discretion of VATSSA staff with good reason and the right to appeal to Division and Region staff by the member.

5.4.4 Requesting a Transfer

Members who are not part of the Europe, Middle East and Africa Region need to visit my.vatsim.net and change region.

Members of the Europe, Middle East and Africa Region need to contact the VATSSA Membership Manager through the SSA Help Desk, or by emailing membership@vatssa.com.

6. Visiting Controllers

6.1 General Eligibility

As per TVCP section 6.1(d), a visiting application can be rejected if:

- The member does not meet the requirements to visit, or
- There is a disciplinary history within the last year, or
- The Allocation being visited has a requirement of a set number of hours for home controllers to remain 'current' that the member has not met. Assessment of this criteria is limited to the preceding two quarters only.

6.2 Visiting VATSSA

6.2.1 General Information

Visiting is open to any VATSIM member who meets the criteria outlined in section 6.2.2 of this policy. A member's historical record, including previous interactions with VATSSA staff and terminal history, will be taken into consideration when reviewing visiting applications.

As per TVCP section 6.1(f), a member cannot hold an official staff post outside of their home region without the approval of both region vice presidents. A member cannot hold an official staff post at another division within their home region without approval of both division directors.

Visiting controllers must control more than 50% of their controlling hours within their home division.

6.2.2 Eligibility & Restrictions

- Hold a VATSIM ATC rating of S3 or above.
- The rating must have been held for 90 days or more.
- The rating must have been used to control for at least 50 hours in the home Division on positions relevant to that rating.

6.2.3 Instructor Ratings

- A visiting Controller shall not control using any instructor rating that may be held.
- Instructor ratings may not be granted to visiting Controllers.
- Visiting Controllers may apply to become mentors at VATSSA.

6.2.4 Processing and Possible Rejection

VATSSA must accept all reasonable visiting Controller requests and process them by the most expeditious means. Grounds for rejection include:

- The member is not eligible to visit VATSSA.
- The member has documented history which must be taken into consideration.

- At the discretion of VATSSA staff with good reason and the right to appeal to Division staff by the member.

6.2.5 Applying for Visiting

Members wishing to apply for visiting in VATSSA should contact the VATSSA Membership Manager through the SSA Help Desk or by emailing membership@vatssa.com.

4.9.6 Revocation of Visiting Status

- The member breaks VATSSA or VATSIM policy.
- Controlling standards are not at the required level.
- Local procedures for controlling are not followed.
- At the discretion of VATSSA staff with good reason and the right to appeal to Division staff by the member.

7. Enforcement

7.1 Disciplinary Action

Failure to comply with this policy may result in sanctions being imposed. Sanctions are at the discretion of VATSSA3 (Membership Manager).

VATSSA reserves the right to restrict or revoke access to divisional services and infrastructure, including training services and communication platforms, in accordance with this policy and other applicable divisional procedures.

8. Authority

- This policy is enforced by the VATSSA Membership Department and authorised by the Division Director.
- Decisions made under this policy are final unless otherwise stated by VATSSA procedures.

9. Review and Amendments

- This policy is subject to biannual review to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness, or when otherwise requested by the Division Director.
- Amendments to this policy may be made by the VATSSA Membership Department as required.
- Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, published at <https://policy.vatssa.com>.